Deliverable 04 – Preliminary Investigation Report: Instructor Consultation Booking System

Author: Md Alamgir Hossain · October 2026 · *Illustrative case study: Walter Dvorak is the course instructor who acted as stakeholder. The interview answers and all figures here are illustrative examples prepared by the student team, not his actual statements.*

The preliminary investigation recommends approving the project and configuring Microsoft Bookings, at about $2,880 one-time and $900 a year, to go live for the Winter 2027 term.

Cover memo

To	Program Head, BIS Program, School of Business
From	Project team (Md Alamgir Hossain, on behalf of the group)
CC	Walter Dvorak, Instructor BIS
Date	October 29, 2026
Subject	Preliminary Investigation Report – Instructor Consultation Booking System

The attached report presents the results of our preliminary investigation into Walter Dvorak's request for an online consultation booking system.

We found that booking by email and a paper door sheet costs the instructor 3–4 hours a week at peak times, causes double-bookings, and leads to about 15% of meetings being missed. We recommend configuring Microsoft Bookings under the college's existing Microsoft 365 licence. It costs about $2,880 one-time and $900 a year, pays back in about 8 months, and can go live for the Winter 2027 term.

We ask for approval to proceed to systems analysis and design, and for IT Services to enable Microsoft Bookings for the instructor's account. We are happy to present the findings at your convenience.

1. Introduction

This report summarizes the preliminary investigation of a request for an Instructor Consultation Booking System. Its purpose is to help the program head decide whether the project should move to the systems analysis phase.

The investigation followed the textbook's preliminary investigation steps (Chapter 2): understand the problem, define the scope and constraints, perform fact-finding, analyze project usability, cost, benefits and schedule, evaluate feasibility, and present the results.

2. Systems request summary

Walter Dvorak, Instructor BIS, main campus, requested a new system in October 2026. Students and project groups book consultations by email and a paper door sheet, which causes 2–4 rounds of email

per booking, double-bookings, missed meetings and no meeting records. He asked for a simple system where students can see his open slots, book and cancel themselves, receive reminders, and where he can keep private notes. The full system request form is in Deliverable 01.

3. Findings

The problem is real, measurable and solvable with tools the college already owns.

Fact-finding: a 30-minute interview with Walter and a questionnaire of 30 students (Deliverable 03); a CATWOE analysis, fishbone diagram and as-is process model (Deliverable 01).

Key findings

1. **Time lost:** 40–60 booking emails a week at peak times, about 3–4 instructor hours a week.
2. **Errors:** 2–3 double-bookings a month, because the paper sheet and Outlook are not linked.
3. **Missed meetings:** about 15% of booked meetings are missed; 60% of students have missed one.
4. **No record:** notes are kept in a personal Excel file, often skipped.
5. **Privacy risk:** student names are posted on a public door sheet.
6. **User demand:** 80% of students find email booking slow; 70% would rather self-book online.

Scope: a booking system for one instructor (Walter), with self-booking, reminders, a dashboard, private notes and basic reports. Use by other instructors is out of scope for this release.

Constraints: little or no budget; must use Microsoft 365 and college logins; must meet FOIP privacy rules; ready before the Winter 2027 term.

Feasibility (Deliverable 02): Option B (Microsoft Bookings) is the only option that is operationally, technically, economically, schedule and legally feasible.

4. Recommendations

Proceed with the project, using Option B: configure Microsoft Bookings.

1. Approve the project to move to the systems analysis and design phase.
2. Ask IT Services to enable Microsoft Bookings for Walter's account, with Outlook and Teams integration.
3. Build the GUI prototype (Deliverable 08) from the final requirements (Deliverable 05) and test it with Walter and a small group of students.
4. Retire the paper door sheet once the system is live.
5. Review use after the first 6 weeks of Winter 2027 before offering it to other instructors.

Options not recommended: doing nothing (problems continue), a custom app (costs more than it saves over 3 years and will not be ready in time) and a commercial service (student data stored outside college systems).

5. Project roles

The project needs five roles; the report format in Chapter 2 asks for them to be named.

Role	Who	Responsibility
Project sponsor	Program Head, BIS	Approves the project and resolves priority conflicts
User and requestor	Walter Dvorak	Confirms requirements, tests the prototype, signs off
Systems analysts	Project team	Analysis, requirements, prototype, documentation
IT support	college IT Services	Enables Microsoft Bookings, SSO, and Outlook and Teams integration
End users	Students in Walter's sections	Use the system; give feedback during testing

6. Project time and cost estimates

The project takes about 9 weeks, from approval on November 9, 2026 to go-live on January 11, 2027 (schedule in Deliverable 02).

Phase	Dates	Effort	Cost
Requirements approval	Nov 9–13, 2026	Team and Walter	$0
Setup and configuration	Nov 16 – Dec 4	40 h IT	$1,800
Outlook and Teams integration, testing	Dec 7–18	16 h IT	$720
Quick reference guide and class demo	Jan 4–8, 2027	8 h	$360
Go-live	**Jan 11, 2027**		**$2,880 one-time**
Ongoing support	Each year	20 h IT	$900 a year

The Microsoft Bookings licence is included in the college's Microsoft 365 subscription, so there is no software cost. Labour is valued at $45 an hour (illustrative rate).

7. Expected benefits

The system saves about $5,250 a year in instructor time and returns 182% over 3 years.

Tangible benefits

- About 105 instructor hours a year freed for teaching and advising (3.5 hours a week × 30 weeks), worth about $5,250 at $50 an hour
- Payback in about 8 months; 3-year net benefit of about $10,170
- Double-bookings reduced from 2–3 a month to none
- Missed meetings reduced from about 15% to a target of under 5%

Intangible benefits

- Faster, easier booking for students, on any device
- A searchable record of every consultation and project-group meeting
- Better privacy: no student names on a public door sheet
- A model other instructors could adopt later

8. Appendix – supporting documents

Document	Deliverable
System request form, problem statement, CATWOE, fishbone diagram, as-is process	Deliverable 01 – Business Case Analysis
Operational, technical, legal, economic and schedule feasibility	Deliverable 02 – Feasibility Assessment
Interview plan, questions, summary, questionnaire results, sign-off	Deliverable 03 – Interview Documents
Final requirements, user stories, use case diagram	Deliverable 05 – Final Requirements

Approval

Role	Name	Decision	Signature	Date
Program Head, BIS		Approve / Reject / Revise		
Requestor	Walter Dvorak			